SEO, AEO, GEO, OXS and AIO

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1. SEO — Search Engine Optimization

The original and most established discipline. SEO is about making your website rank higher on Google, Bing, and similar search engines so people find you through blue-link results.

Key pillars:

- **On-page SEO** — keywords in titles, headings, meta descriptions, and content
- **Technical SEO** — site speed, crawlability, mobile-friendliness, XML sitemaps
- **Off-page SEO** — backlinks, domain authority, brand mentions
- **Content** — E-E-A-T (Experience, Expertise, Authoritativeness, Trustworthiness)

Goal: Rank on page 1 of Google for targeted queries.

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2. AEO — Answer Engine Optimization

AEO focuses on getting your content selected as the *direct answer* — featured snippets, People Also Ask boxes, and voice assistant responses (Siri, Alexa, Google Assistant).

Key tactics:

- Write in Q&A format — ask the question, then answer it directly below
- Use structured data / schema markup (FAQ, How-To, Article schemas)
- Keep answers concise (40–60 words for snippets)
- Use clear headings that mirror how people ask questions

Goal: Be the answer shown at the top, even before the blue links.

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3. GEO — Generative Engine Optimization

GEO is about getting your brand/content cited and recommended by AI chatbots like ChatGPT, Gemini, Perplexity, and Claude when users ask them questions.

Key tactics:

- Get mentioned on authoritative third-party sites (Wikipedia, Reddit, major publications) that AI models train on
- Publish well-cited, original research and statistics

- Use clear brand language and entity associations in your content
- Optimize for Perplexity's web citations and ChatGPT's browse mode
- Build a consistent digital footprint across the web

Goal: When someone asks an AI about your niche, your brand gets mentioned.

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4. OXS — Optimization for Experience & Search (also seen as "Search Experience Optimization")

OXS is the intersection of UX design and SEO — optimizing the *experience* users have on your site, since Google now uses user signals as ranking factors.

Key pillars:

- **Core Web Vitals** — LCP (loading), FID/INP (interactivity), CLS (visual stability)
- **Dwell time & bounce rate** — keeping users engaged signals quality to Google
- **Navigation & findability** — clear information architecture
- **Conversion optimization** — aligning SEO traffic with business goals
- **Mobile-first design** — Google indexes mobile version first

Goal: Rank higher AND convert better by making the experience genuinely good.

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5. AIO — AI Optimization (also: AI Overview Optimization)

The newest discipline. AIO focuses specifically on appearing in Google's **AI Overviews** (formerly SGE) — the AI-generated summaries at the very top of Google search results — as well as optimizing content for how AI systems read and process it.

Key tactics:

- Write comprehensive, clearly structured content (AI Overviews pull from multiple sections)
- Use concise, factual language — AI summarizers prefer clarity
- Have strong topical authority (cover a subject deeply, not broadly)
- Get cited by sources AI models trust (high DA sites, news outlets)
- Use semantic HTML and clean formatting so AI can parse your content easily
- Keep content up to date — AI Overviews favor fresh, accurate information

Goal: Get your content surfaced inside Google's AI-generated answer block, and be the source AI systems cite.

How they fit together

Disciplie	Optimizing for	Key signal
SEO	Google/Bing rankings	Links + keywords
AEO	Direct answer boxes / voice	Schema + Q&A format
GEO	AI chatbot recommendations	Brand authority + citations
OXS	User experience + rankings	Core Web Vitals + engagement
AIO	Google AI Overviews	Topical depth + clarity

In 2025+, the smartest strategy combines all five — strong SEO foundations, AEO-optimized content structure, GEO brand building, OXS user experience, and AIO-ready content formatting.